

RACE

THE WTCC GAME



True to the simulation mantra

Race, a simulation game based on the FIA WTCC championships lets you experience the WTCC 2006 championship seasons. Everything a simulation fanatic could possibly ask for is crammed into this game—in addition to the rules, the tracks and the cars, the drivers will also appear familiar to anyone following the WTCC craze. Yes, that also includes 2005 WTCC champion Andy Priaulx. Race goes to great lengths to ensure that players experience as much realism as possible; this includes the penalty weight system in championship mode and a realistic damage system where your cars crumble, break and bend. Even debris hitting your car can damage it, so don't go full speed ahead in glee, and watch out when you see the cars ahead of you encounter a nasty accident.

You can play Race mainly in the Quick Race, Championship and Race Weekend modes. The two additional modes—Driver Duel and Time Attack—add a bit of spice to the game, despite being a bit similar. And of course, there's multiplayer where up to 26 players can race with each other.

Moving to the core of the game—simulation—Race does it extremely well; no two cars feel the same when driving, and the amount of flexibility to customise your cars is simply huge. Even expert tuners will be impressed at the large amount of tuning in Race; you can even customise

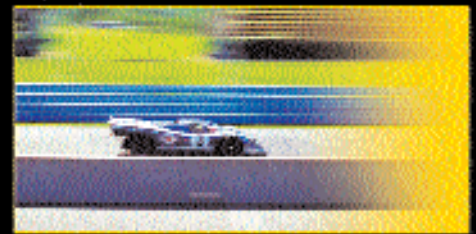
each tire and its height individually! Even in-game, small factors matter—your windshield could get smudged by the weather or dirt, and stones could smash it.

The graphics aren't overly detailed, but they feel smooth to look at and won't hamper your playing experience. As already implied before, the physics are awesome; any realistic game should pay attention to physics, and Race has pinpointed its every aspect.

The amount of difficulty options in Race brings even the toughest of the skilled players down to their knees, however novice gamers will have some difficulty getting used to the game. SimBin has taken this into account and even included mouse steering for players finding controlling with the keyboard too difficult.

Race is a great game with few quirks, one of them that you can't see where your steering wheel is pointed when controlling your car with a mouse in chase cam. Also be warned that the game comes with Steam, which means you will need an internet connection at least once to be able to play even in single player mode. Anyone who has ever used Steam can testify to its ability to cause severe hair loss! At the end though, it's all worth it if you are a simulation fanatic.

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